



Accept the license agreement during the installation

system. The documentation for the Android SDK suggests that you install the JDK (Java Development Kit) version of Java; but unless you are a developer all you really need is the standard version of Java, which is officially called the Java SE Runtime Environment—if you are downloading it using Internet Explorer, it might be listed as “Java for Windows Internet Explorer.”

Once you confirm that Java is properly installed, the next step is to download the Android SDK Starter Package—you’ll be downloading a zip file. When you unzip it you should have a folder called android-sdk-windows. You can put this folder anywhere you want on your computer—everything runs out of this folder and there is no software to install in the traditional sense. Just remember where you put the folder, because no shortcuts or desktop icons get created unless you do so manually.

Navigate to the android-sdk-windows folder and launch SDK Setup.exe, which is the Android SDK and AVD Manager application.

If Java is not properly installed, an error message will pop up stating that Java cannot be found.

If this is the first time you’ve run the Android SDK and AVD Manager, you might see a Refresh Sources window that says the repository can’t be found. If you do, you’ll have to change the SDK’s settings to use HTTP, instead of the default HTTPS. To do this, click Close. Next you’ll see a “Choose Packages to Install” window, but with nothing listed. Click Cancel. The next window you should see is the Android SDK and AVD Manager window. Select the Settings tab and in the Misc section enable the “Force https://... Sources to be fetched using http://...” setting.

Now select the Available Packages tab. You should see a single site in the

list: <https://dl-ssl.google.com/android/repository/repository.xml>. Select this site and a list of packages should appear below it. If you want to play around with the different versions of the Android OS then enable all the packages.

If you only want to use Android 2.2, then the only packages you’ll need to download are “Documentation for Android SDK, API8, revision 1”; “SDK Platform Android 2.2, API8, revision 1”; “Samples for SDK API8, revision 1”; and Google APIs by Google Inc., Android API8, revision 1.”

Once you’ve selected the packages you want to download, click the “Install Selected” button. This opens the “Choose Packages to Install” window, with all of the previously selected packages listed. (If you didn’t encounter the HTTPS error when you first launched the SDK then this is the first screen you should see.) Don’t hit the Install button

quite yet. You’ll notice that some of the listed packages have question marks next to them. This means that you have to accept the license agreement for each of these packages before you can install them. Select each package that has a question mark next to it and click the Accept button. Once all the packages have check marks next to them go ahead and click the Install button.

If you chose to install all of the available packages, it may take a few minutes to download them all. When it is done, you’ll see a window that says something like “Done, 12 packages installed.” Click Close.

Creating an Android Virtual Device

Now you’re finally ready to create your very first virtual Android device! The Android SDK actually refers to this as an Android Virtual Device or AVD—which is what we will be calling it from here on out. Select the Virtual Devices tab and click on the New button.

This opens a Create new Android



Android Virtual Device running



A few apps running on the new AVD

Virtual Device (AVD) window. There’s actually not much to creating an AVD. All you really need to do are: Name. Give the AVD a name. Pretty much any name will do that uses alphanumeric characters.

Target: Here is where you pick the version of the Android OS that the AVD will be based on. For this example, choose Android 2.2.

SD Card Size: This is where you choose the size of the AVD’s virtual SD card. The SD Card size must be at least 9MB. For